

married.”

“We should be able to qualify for some grants if we’re married,” Andrea responded enthusiastically. “And besides, we’ll have your student loans to help live on while you’re in grad school.”

The more Bill thought about the idea, the more it appealed to him. Graduation was only two months away, and then Andrea would be finished. They had planned to get married that next summer anyway and only have a simple ceremony with their families, so what difference would a couple of months make?

*Besides, he thought, Andrea’s right. Her mother is certainly in no shape to go through a wedding.* “I think it’s a great idea,” he said as he put his arms around her. “When would you like to get married?”

“What about right now?” she said.

“Right now?” Bill echoed as he looked at his watch. “But it’s nearly eleven o’clock, and we have classes tomorrow. Besides, we have to wait at least three days for the blood tests.”

“We could miss Friday’s classes,” she argued, a little hurt that Bill was hesitating. “And we can always drive to Virginia—there’s no waiting period and they don’t require a blood test.” Andrea’s cousin had told her this, and she had verified the information on the Internet.

“But Andrea, that’s nearly two hundred miles away. I don’t even have gas money right now.”

“I’ve got my credit cards,” she responded eagerly. “It wouldn’t cost that much, and we could stop down in Bristol on the way back and see my dad’s sister. She’s been wanting me to come and visit. It would be like a little honeymoon.”

Bill had a nagging feeling inside about doing something this serious on impulse. He wondered what his parents, especially his mother, would say when she found out. But seeing Andrea so excited and knowing that they did love each other, he could come up with no logical arguments that would satisfy her. So he said,